CYBERSECURITY
& INFRASTRUCTURE
SECURITY AGENCY

SECURITY ASSESSMENT AT FIRST ENTRY (SAFE) Version 2.2

User Manual

November 2022

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Introduction

The purpose of this document is to provide an overview and instructions for the successful use of the Security Assessment at First Entry (SAFE) 2.2 tool. SAFE is intended to help facility owners and operators interested in evaluating their current physical and operational security practices and exploring opportunities to protect against relevant threats. The tool itself is designed to allow a Protective Security Advisor (PSA) to walk through a facility, make quick observations, and record preliminary findings to pass on to facility owners and operators in a very short period of time. To do this, standard vulnerabilities and options for consideration (VOFCs) are the centerpiece so that PSAs can communicate already vetted concepts with references and resources, tailored to the situation at each facility. The tool also allows the PSA to add a limited number of custom VOFCs to allow for a greater degree of specificity when needed. The overall tool is customer-focused, easy-to-use, and can be completed after a 1-2 hour walkthrough and no more than 1 hour of product development.

The current version is SAFE 2.2 last modified November 2, 2022. Version 2.2 is very similar to version 2.0 with several improvements. See Table 1 for a brief description of version updates.

TABLE 1.—SAFE Version Updates.

Version	Features/Updates	Browser Support	Date
1.6	Original release main functions: VOFCs commendables, POC, Links, Report	Internet Explorer – no longer used	January 15, 2020
2.0	Updated browser compatibility, bug fixes	Edge, Chrome, Firefox	September 2, 2020
2.2	Added “other” VOFC and commendables category, added image gallery, link updates, bug fixes	Edge, Chrome, Firefox	November 3, 2022

SAFE Organization

The structure of the files in version 2.2 are slightly different from previous versions to accommodate the addition of the image gallery. Be sure to keep the .html file called SAFE V2.2 and the images folder in the same place. For example, create a folder named SAFE and add the SAFE V2.2 file and the images folder that came with the SAFE download in that created folder (see figure 1). When operating the SAFE, navigate to this folder and double-click on the SAFE V2.2 file to operate the tool.

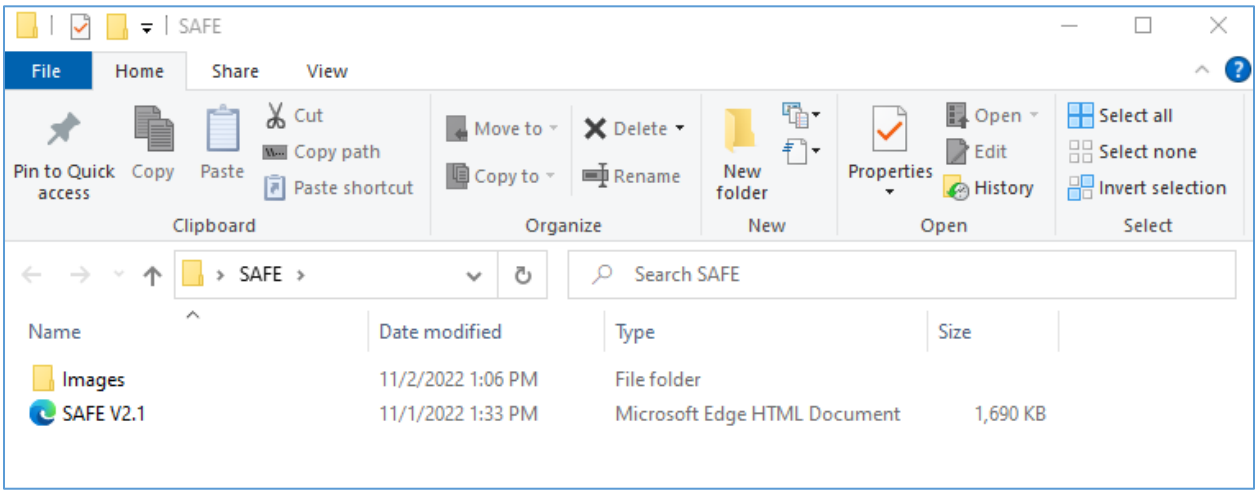


FIGURE 1.—SAFE Files.

The SAFE is organized similarly to the layout of the Infrastructure Survey Tool (IST) with the topics on the left-hand side organized in tabs (see figure 2). In the SAFE, the main topics are further broken down into four main categories: Information Sharing/Communication, Plans, Physical Security, and Security Systems. This makes the task of taking notes while walking around a facility much easier. The categories found in the IST are still there but are now subcategories, as shown in table 2. Although the SAFE covers some resilience concepts, it focuses mostly on physical security and includes no dependency data.

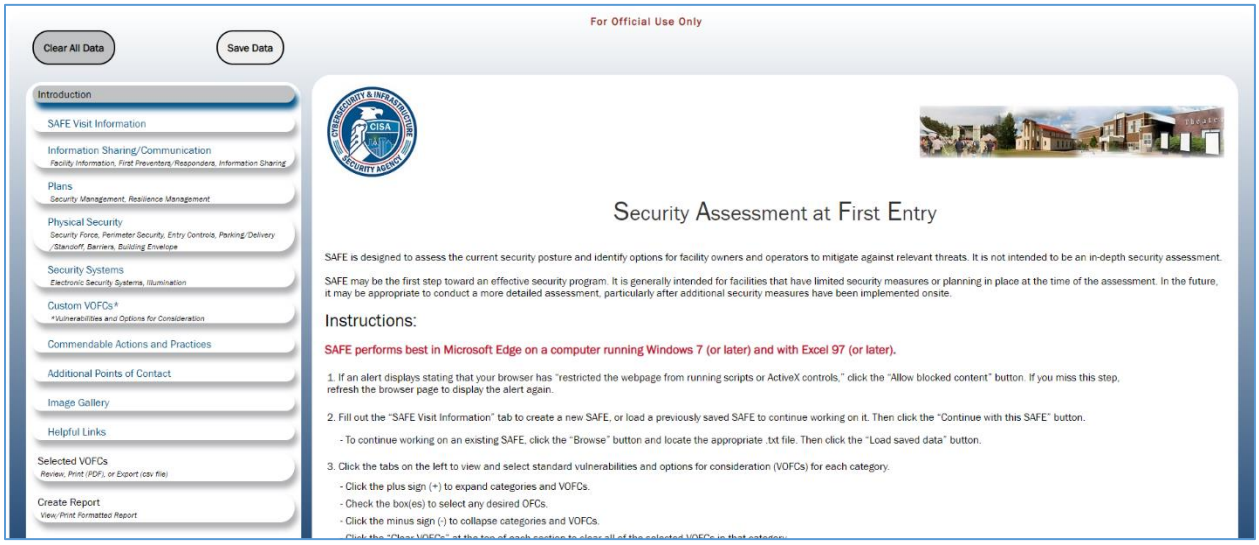


FIGURE 2.—SAFE Organization.

TABLE 2.—SAFE and IST Category Comparison.

SAFE Category	Corresponding IST Categories
Information Sharing/Communication	Facility Information, First Preventers/Responders, Information Sharing
Plans	Security Management, Resilience Management
Physical Security	Security Force, Perimeter Security, Entry Controls, Parking/Delivery/Standoff, Barriers, Building Envelope
Security Systems	Electronic Security Systems, Illumination

Beginning a SAFE

The SAFE 2.2 is designed to be used in the Edge browser and the Chrome browser. The tool works well with Firefox as well, but users may experience some issues in that browser.

To open the tool, double-click on the HTML file named SAFE V2.2. If you want to use it in a browser that is not your default browser, right-click on the HTML icon, select “Open with,” and choose the preferred browser.

To begin a SAFE, start on the SAFE Visit Information tab (see figure 3). This tab contains text boxes for the PSA name and contact information as well as important information about the facility. Some fields include the PSA point of contact (POC) information, infrastructure sector, and the comparison group that the IST uses. Use the drop-down menus to complete the Sector, Comparison Group, and the Leadership Directed Outreach fields. The SAFE does not compare data, but this field aids in categorization and metrics of the facility types that have received a SAFE. Click the “Continue with this SAFE” button after filling out all text fields.

This page also contains the ability to load data saved from a previous session of SAFE. To do this, click the “Browse” button at the top of the page, find and select the desired file, and click the “Open” button. Then click the “Load selected data” button to the right of the “Browse” button to load the data.

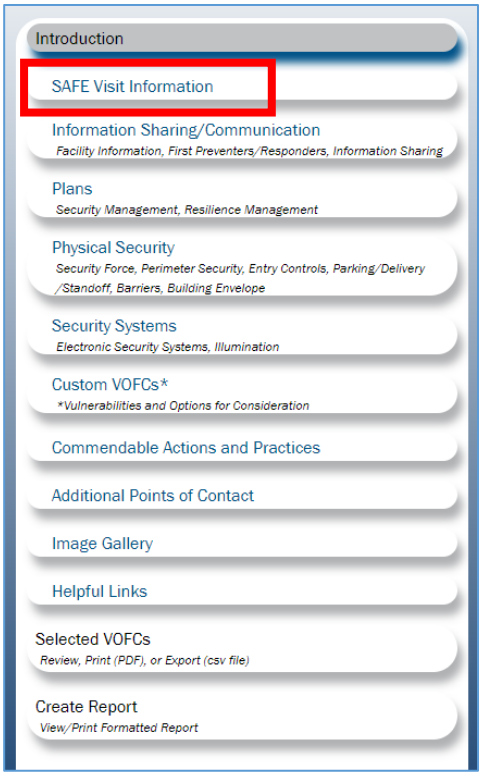


FIGURE 3.—SAFE Visit Information Tab.

VOFCs

The SAFE tool focuses on a set of VOFCs that the PSA can select to communicate security and resilience concepts to a facility's owner and operator. Because of the number of VOFCs available, they have been split into several main categories as described above. The main categories are further divided into the same categories that the IST uses in order to maintain continuity, since most of the VOFCs used in the SAFE are the same or similar as those used in the IST. All standard VOFCs in the SAFE tool are contained in the Information Sharing/Communication, Plans, Physical Security, and Security Systems tabs (see figure 4).

To select VOFCs, click on the desired tab and expand the subsection by clicking on the "+" sign next to the subsection name. This will reveal the available vulnerabilities for that subsection. Expand the Options for Consideration by clicking the "+" sign next to each vulnerability, and chose the desired options for consideration by checking the boxes. PSAs can selected as many VOFCs as they like for any one SAFE report (see figure 5).

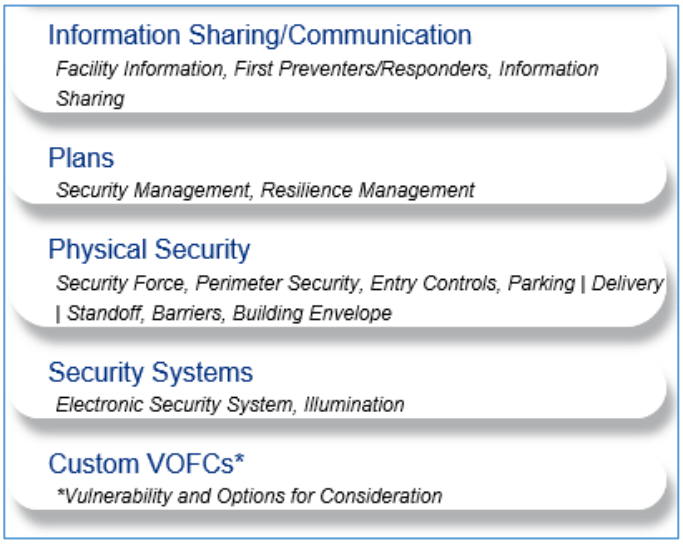


FIGURE 4.—Tabs Containing VOFCs.

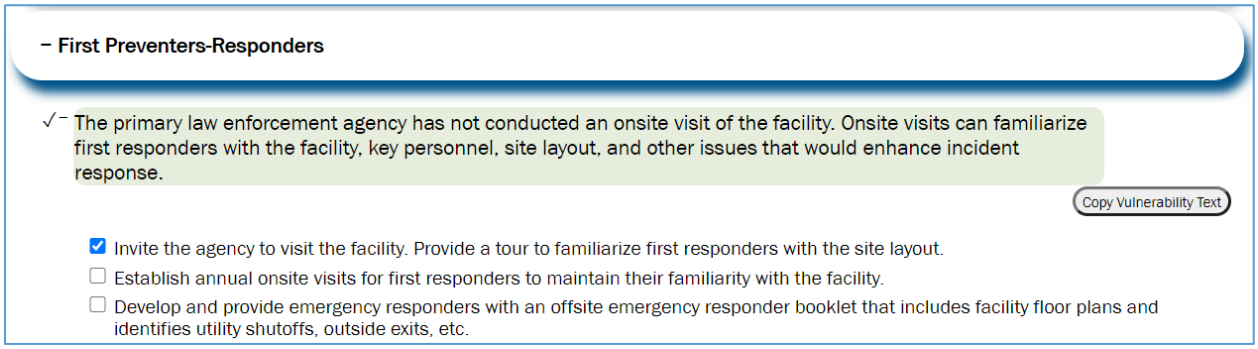


FIGURE 5.—VOFC Selection Process.

The tool allows a PSA to enter 10 custom VOFCs to keep the process short and avoid large text areas that will need editing. To use this function, click on the Custom VOFC tab and then click on "Custom Vulnerability 1" to open the section (see figure 6). Use the drop-down to identify the appropriate category, and enter the vulnerability and the option for consideration in the respective text fields. New in version 2.2 is an "other" category if the VOFC does not fit one of the provided categories. For tips about writing good custom VOFCs, see *IST Version 5 Report Guidance* found on the IST help menu.

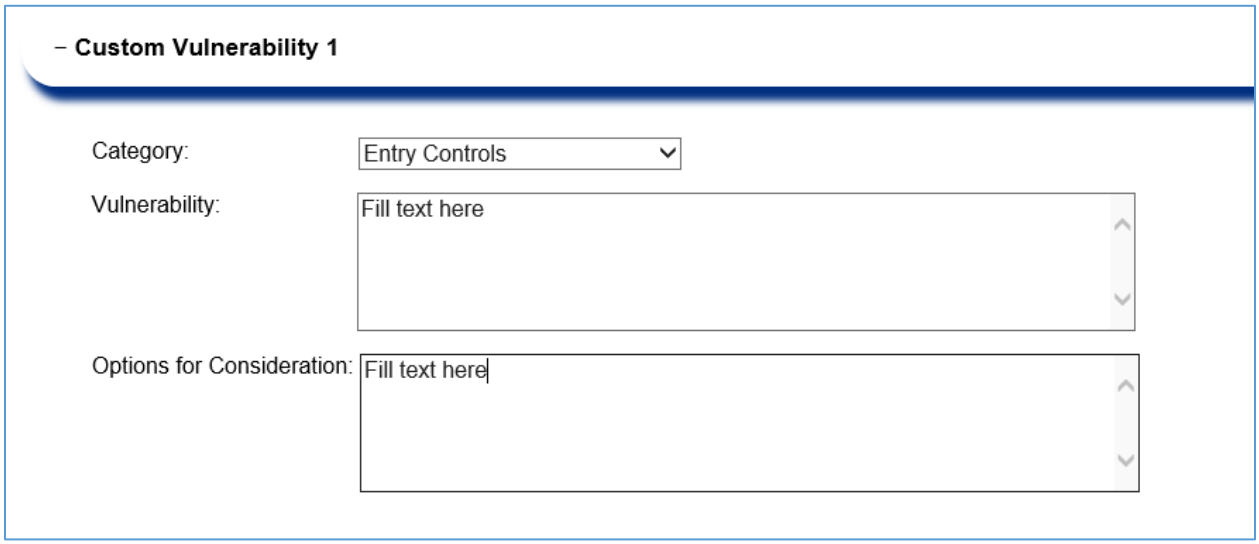
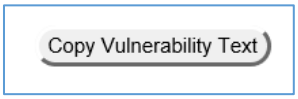


FIGURE 6.—Custom VOFCs.

To use an existing vulnerability but create a new option for consideration for it, copy the vulnerability text using the "Copy Vulnerability Text" button located below each vulnerability. Once copied, paste the vulnerability text into the Vulnerability text box in the custom VOFCs tab, and add one or more custom options for consideration.



Commendable Actions and Practices

SAFE allows PSAs to capture areas where a facility specifically excels or is doing something that should be encouraged to continue. To add a commendable action, go to the Commendable Actions and Practices tab. Next, find the respective category where the commendable belongs and add the

text to the appropriate box (see figure 7). New in version 2.2 is an “other” category if the commendable does not fit one of the provided categories. For tips about writing good commendable actions, see *IST Version 5 Report Guidance* found on the IST help menu. The text will then automatically display in the Commendable Actions and Practices table in the final report. If no commendable actions are added in the tool, that section will not appear in the report.

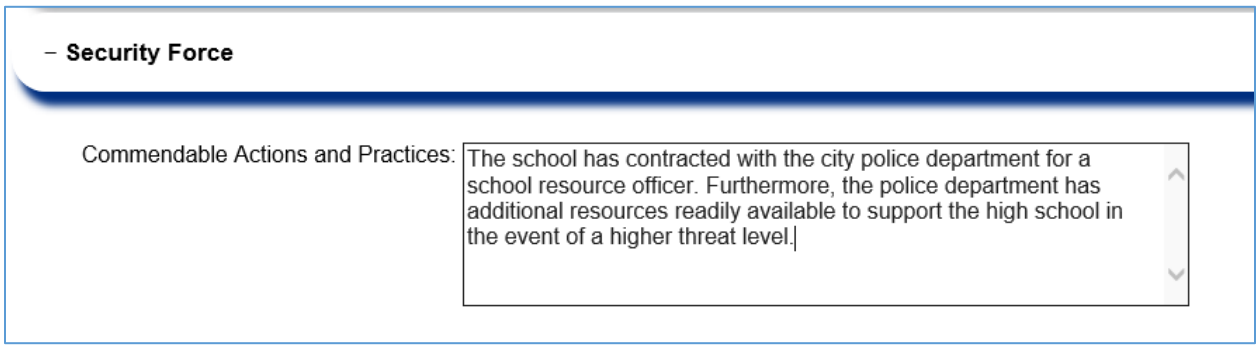


FIGURE 7.—Commendable Actions and Practices.

Points of Contact

The SAFE Points of Contact tab allows PSAs to communicate outside points of contact to a facility owner or operator such as local fire and law enforcement, other federal agencies, or industry experts. PSA can add up to 10 POCs. Any POCs entered will appear at the end of the SAFE report. Note: the place for the PSA’s information is on the SAFE Visit Information tab, so do not add that information here. If no external POCs are added, the POC section will not appear in the final report.

Image Gallery

New in SAFE 2.2 is a place to upload images from the SAFE visit. The images selected in the image gallery will be displayed at the end of the report. The gallery provides a place to upload images and add a relevant caption. An important part of using the image gallery feature in SAFE is a security feature that keeps your username from being seen when saving the SAFE data. This means that the user will need to place all images in a specific location every time. Your SAFE download package came with a folder called “Images.” You must first place your images there before using the Image Gallery tab to import the images. You can create new folders in the image folder to organize your images as desired, but the images folder itself (including the name) must remain located in the same place as the HTML SAFE V2.2 file described above.

1. Place all images in the image folder that came with the SAFE download package.
2. Go to the Image Gallery tab and click the “Choose File” button which will open a navigation window
3. Navigate to the images folder and select the desired image and click open. The image will appear to the right of the image caption field.
4. Add a caption in the Image Caption text field
5. Click “Add to Image Gallery” which will add an image thumbnail below the Image Caption text field

6. Add more images as desired
7. Preview the images by clicking the Create Report tab
    - The images will appear in the preview window
    - To see the images in the report, see the "Create Report" section below

The final option available in the Image Gallery tab is the ability to delete images. To delete an image from the SAFE interface, locate the image you want to delete and click the blue trashcan icon next to the image thumbnail (see figure 8). This will delete the image in the SAFE interface but will NOT delete it from your computer.

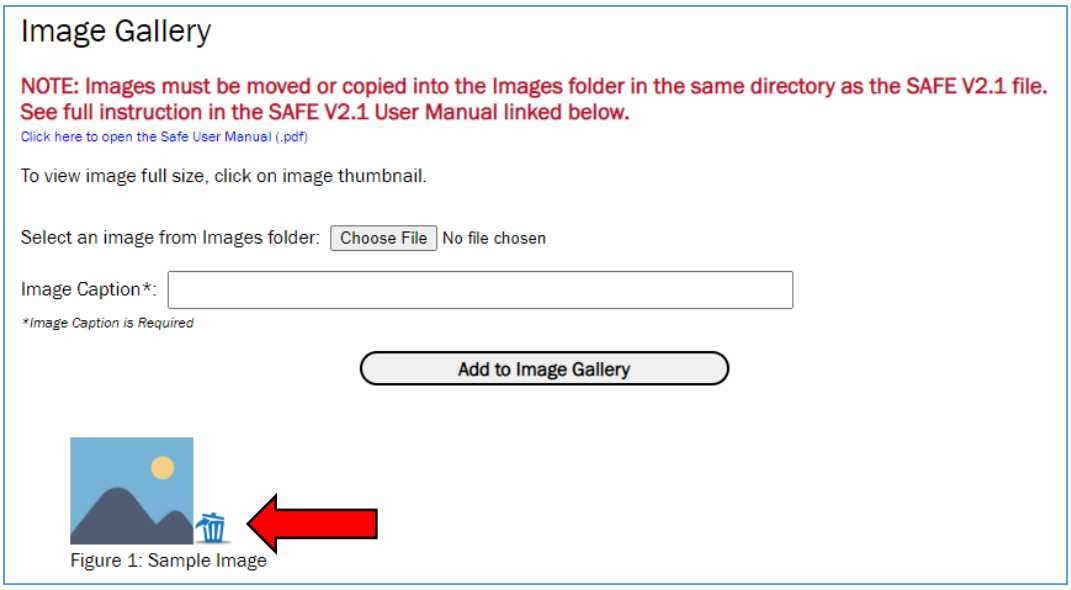


FIGURE 8.—Delete Image from Gallery.

Selected VOFCs

Since more than 300 vulnerabilities and 1,000 options for consideration can be added to any one SAFE report, keeping track of what VOFCs have been chosen and what the VOFC table may look like in the report can be difficult. The Selected VOFCs tab builds the VOFC table as VOFCs are selected in the tool. Clicking on the selected VOFCs tab will display a preview of the table without the need to generate a report. This table can be exported to Excel; however, because of DHS security settings, users must manually format the Excel document. To export the table, click the "Export to Excel" button at the bottom of the tab. This will open a dialogue box at the bottom of the screen. Click "Open" and follow the following instructions for formatting.

1. Open the .csv file in Excel
2. Resize the columns
    - Click the triangle in the corner between row 1 and column A
    - On the Home tab in the "Cells" group, click "Format," and select "AutoFit Column Width"

- Click on Column A to highlight it. On the Home tab in the “Cells” group, click “Format” and select “column width.” Enter 20
- Repeat with Column B; set width to 50
- Repeat with Column C; set width to 50

3. Format the columns
   - Click the triangle in the corner between row 1 and column A
   - On the Home tab in the “Alignment” group, click “Wrap Text”
4. Prepare to print
   - On the Page Layout tab in the “Page Setup” group, click “Orientation” and select “Landscape”
   - On the Page Layout tab in the “Sheet Options” group, click the expand arrow in the bottom right corner; a “Page Setup” window will display
     - On the Sheet tab, check the “Gridlines” box
     - On the Page tab, check the “Fit to” radio button and make sure a “1” is in the first text field. NOTE: the second text field should have as many pages as needed for the number of records
     - Click the “OK” button
5. Save the file
   - Go to “File,” “Save As,” and choose a location to save the file
   - Name the file. Suggested naming convention:
     “Facility Name_VOFCs_MMDDYYYY”
     Example: XYZ Church_VOFCs_03192019
   - Change the “Save as type” drop-down to “Excel Workbook”
   - Click the “Save” button

The resulting Excel spreadsheet is a sortable list of VOFCs that the PSA can give to the facility owner or operator to prioritize and assign VOFCs to members of the organization for completion. The instructions above are also on the Selected VOFCs tab within the SAFE tool.

Create Report

Once all the desired information is added to the SAFE tool, generate the report by clicking the Create Report tab. A report preview will open in the content window. From there the report can be viewed, printed, and saved. Since the report opens in the content window, right-click anywhere on the report preview and select “Print.” If preferred, use the browser settings to print and/or save the report. Note: the process of creating a PDF document involves using the “Save as PDF” function. This does not actually print the document, however. Once the PDF is created using the below steps, the document can be printed like any other PDF document.

Create a PDF Document

To create a PDF and send to an owner or operator, complete the following steps:

1. Right-click anywhere on the report preview
2. When the right-click menu appears, click “Print” (see figure 9) to enter the print preview.
3. Once the print preview menu appears, select “Save as PDF” from the drop-down menu and click the “Save” button (see figure 10).

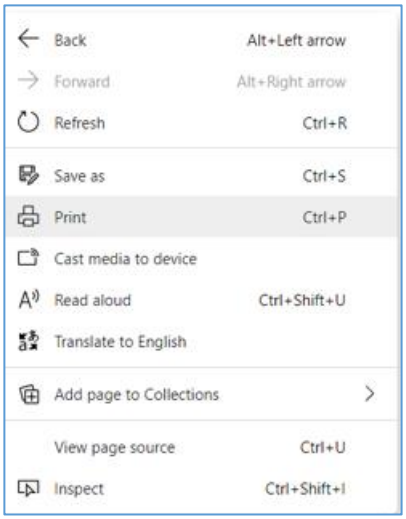


FIGURE 9.—Right-Click Menu.

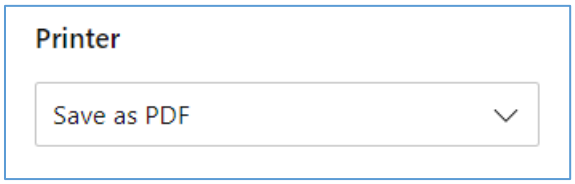


FIGURE 10.—Print Settings.

4. Once the “Save as” menu appears, browse to the preferred location, name the document, and click the “Save” button (see figure 11). Suggested naming convention: “Facility Name_SAFE Report_MMDDYYYY” (Example: XYZChurch_SAFE Report_10252022)

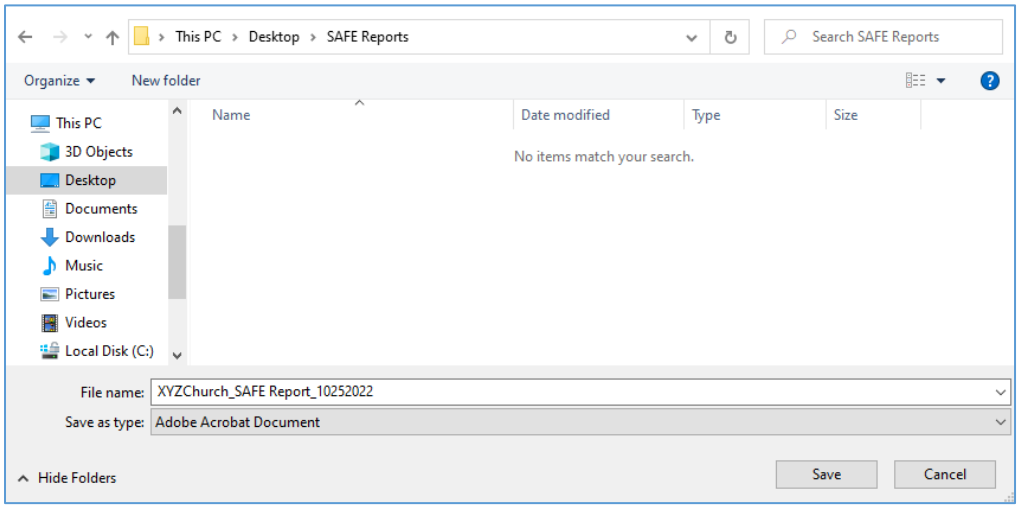


FIGURE 11.—Print Menu.

5. Note: Edits to the report’s content cannot be made within the PDF; make any changes via the SAFE tool, and then recreate the report.

Add a Password to the PDF

The resulting PDF document is For Official Use Only (FOUO). This means that before sending the PDF document via email, you must password-protect it. To password-protect the document, follow the instructions below.

1. With the PDF document open, click “File.”
2. Click “Properties” to make the document properties menu appear.
3. Click on the Security tab to find the security method (see figure 12)
4. Use the drop-down to select password security.

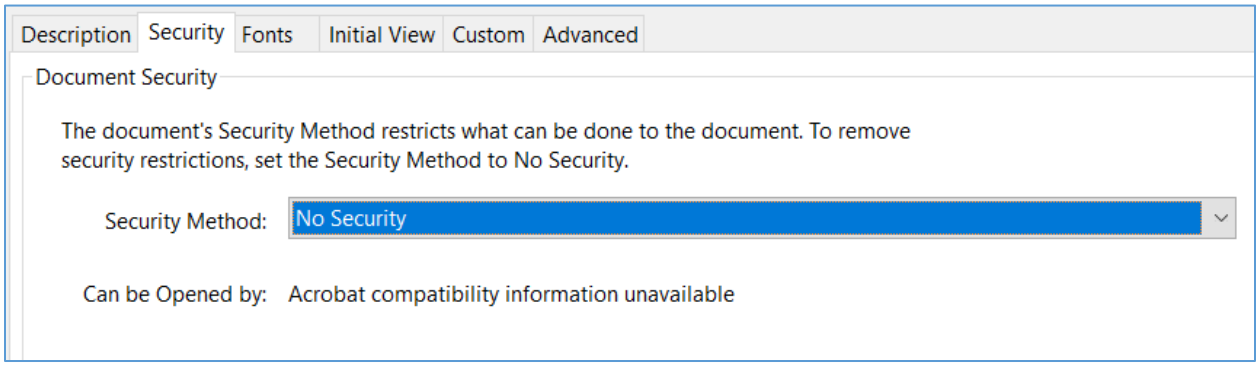


FIGURE 12.—Security Tab Settings.

5. Check the “Require a password to open the document” box (see figure 13).

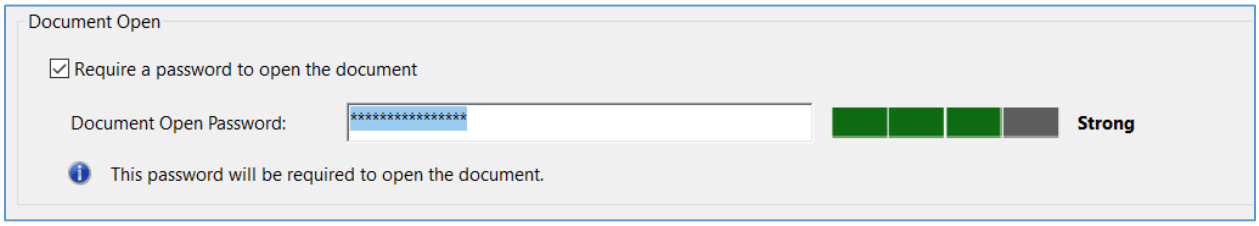


FIGURE 13.—Document Password.

6. Create a unique password and click the “OK” button.
7. Another dialogue box will appear to confirm the password; retype the password and click the “Ok” button.
8. Click the “Ok” button again to exit all menus and save the document; when next opening the document, a password will be required.
9. Once the PDF report is created and password-protected, it is ready to be emailed to a facility owner or operator.

Saving, and Recalling Data

Saving Data

To save complete or partial data in the SAFE, use the "Save Data" button at the top left of the SAFE tool. The button is accessible from any tab at any time during the SAFE data-entry process. Click the "Save Data" button to begin the process. A pop-up message warning will display stating that the data file is FOUO and should not be transmitted via email (see figure 14). To acknowledge the warning, click the "OK" button.

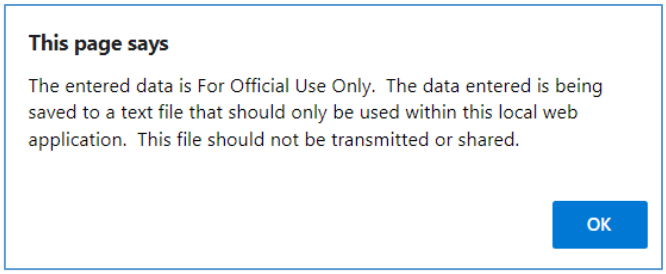


FIGURE 14.—FOUO Warning Message.

After acknowledging the FOUO warning, a download box will appear in the upper right corner of the browser window. Place your pointer over the icon that looks like a folder and click it (see figure 15). That will open the download folder where the file is saved automatically. In the folder find the file which should be at the top of the list. From there rename the file, right-click on the file, select cut and then past the file into a preferred folder location.

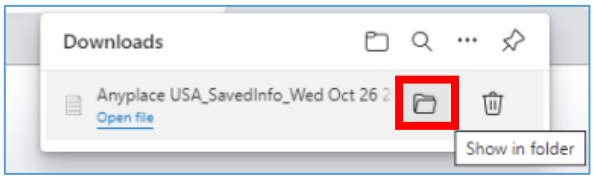


FIGURE 15.—Downloads Pop-up Box

Recalling Saved Data

To retrieve data from a previously saved SAFE session, go to the SAFE Visit Information tab. On the top section of that tab, under the SAFE Information heading, click the "Browse" button and navigate to the previously saved file (see figure 16). Select the file and click the "Load selected saved data" button; all the data will load into the SAFE tool. Any changes made to that data will need to be saved to an updated file.

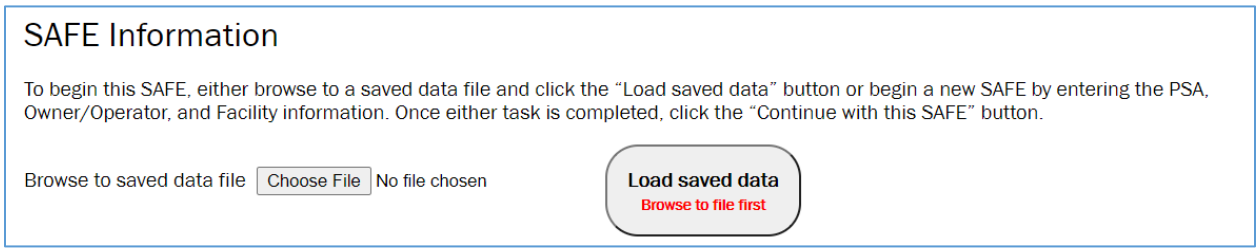


FIGURE 16.—Loading Selected Data.

For questions contact ISDAssessments@cisa.dhs.gov.